

People often write added-detail fragments for much the same reason they write *-ing* fragments. They think the subject and verb in one sentence will serve for the next word group as well. But the subject and verb must be in *each* word group.

Correcting Added-Detail Fragments

- 1 Attach the fragment to the complete thought that precedes it. Example 1 could read: "I love to cook and eat Italian food, especially spaghetti and lasagna."
- 2 Add a subject and a verb to the fragment to make it a complete sentence. Example 2 could read: "The class often starts late. For example, yesterday it began at a quarter after nine instead of at nine sharp."
- 3 Change words as necessary to make the fragment part of the preceding sentence. Example 3 could read: "Among the courses he failed before he earned his degree were English I, Economics, and General Biology."

Activity 1

Underline the fragment in each of the items below. Then make it a sentence by rewriting it, using the method described in parentheses.

Example I am always short of pocket money. Especially for everyday items like magazines and sodas. Luckily my friends often have change.
(Add the fragment to the preceding sentence.)

I am always short of pocket money, especially for everyday items like magazines and sodas.

1. There are many little things wrong with this apartment. For example, defective lights and leaking faucets. The landlord is not good about making repairs.
(Correct the fragment by adding the subject and verb *it has*.)

There are ... For example, it has defective ... The landlord ... repairs.

2. I could feel Bill's anger building. Like a land mine ready to explode. I was silent because I didn't want to be the one to set it off.
(Add the fragment to the preceding sentence.)

I could feel ... building, like a ... explode. I was ... it off.

3. We went on vacation without several essential items. Among other things, our sneakers and sweat jackets.

(Correct the fragment by adding the subject and verb we forgot.)

We went ... items. Among other things, we forgot our sneakers ... jackets.

Activity 2

3 sep.

Underline the added-detail fragment in each item. Then rewrite that part of the item needed to correct the fragment. Use one of the three methods of correction described above.

1. It's always hard for me to get up for work. Especially on Monday after a holiday weekend. However, I always wake up early on free days.

1) It's always ... work, especially on Monday ... weekend. However, I ... days.

2)

2. Tony has enormous endurance. For example, the ability to run five miles in the morning and then play basketball all afternoon.

1) Tony has ... endurance. For example, he has the ability ... of afternoon.

3. A counselor gives you a chance to talk about your problems. With your family or the boss at work. You learn how to cope better with life.

1) A counselor ... problems with your ... work. You learn ... life.

4. Fred and Martha do most of their shopping through mail-order catalogs. Especially the J. C. Penney catalog.

1) Fred and ... catalogs, especially ... J.C. Penney catalog.

5. One of my greatest joys in life is eating desserts. Such as cherry cheesecake and vanilla cream puffs. Almond fudge cake makes me want to dance.

1) One of my ... desserts, such as ... Puffs. Almond ... dance.

2)